block before we reached an agreement: For understandable reasons of history and geography, I wrote, the Soviet strategic forces were made up almost exclusively of land-based intercontinental-range missiles while the United States had a three-tiered force of land-, sea-, and air-launched missiles.

Since we were dealing to some extent with apples and oranges, I wrote that reaching an equitable agreement would be hard but not impossible; from our perspective, the most destabilizing aspect of the nuclear arms race was the Soviets' substantial edge over the United States in long-range missiles, but I said we were prepared to discuss trade-offs that acknowledged the differences in our forces and bridged the proposals of both sides. The INF weapons in Europe, I wrote, were obviously a major sticking point in our relations, and if the Soviets had any new ideas on how to deal with the impasse, we would pay attention to them. In the meantime, I suggested we move ahead on other issues, including work on a treaty to ban chemical weapons and begin the development of better communications and procedures to avert miscalculations or misunderstandings that might lead to disaster during an international crisis:

> Mr. General Secretary, following his visit to Moscow, Vice President Bush conveyed to me your message that we should take steps to insure that history recalls us as leaders known to be good, wise and kind. Nothing is more important to me, and we should take steps to bring this about.

Referring to the Soviet decision to allow the Pentecostalist families to emigrate to America, I wrote that I was

> touched by that gesture and in my view, it showed how quiet and sincere efforts could solve even the most sensitive problems in our relationship. Similar